Input Assumptions

shg_mode_survey · loss model + material dispersion, referenced by every results report

Every per-sweep PDF this project produces should cite this document rather than re-stating or re-deriving any assumption. Two bands matter throughout: SH = 215–235 nm (deep UV), pump = 430–470 nm (true blue) — shaded orange and blue respectively in every chart below.

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STATUS AT TIME OF WRITING

AlN, SiNx, TiO2 dispersion: committed, wired into at least one geometry family.
AlN's own UV k(lambda): still open (candidate sources span ~4 orders of magnitude, PLAN.md).
ScAlN: index fitted (8 compositions, Baumler 2019). UV k and chi(2) d33/d31 vs. Sc fraction are disputed between sputtered and MBE literature — see section 6.
GaAlN: no dispersion fit exists yet. Section 5 documents the gap, not a fix.

1. Loss model: scattering + absorption

Scattering (native EMode, Volume Current Method)

Sidewall (vertical): 2.5 nm RMS roughness, 50 nm correlation length.
Top/bottom (horizontal): 0.3 nm RMS roughness, 10 nm correlation length.
Values as currently used in survey_config.py. The "Loss Model Summary" memo (see section 2) used 2 nm sidewall RMS instead — everything else matches.

Absorption (non-uniform, growth-interface defects)

Each mechanism: a local power-absorption coefficient (alpha0, dB/m) at a physical boundary, decaying into the core (exponential or step) over a penetration depth L (nm). Modal loss is the Poynting-flux-weighted average of that profile over the mode. Currently active in survey_config.py's pump_absorption_mechanisms (4 of them; sh_absorption_mechanisms is empty — AlN itself is assumed to contribute ZERO absorption at the SH wavelength):

Dislocations `2000 dB/m, exp, 40nm`

Chen et al., Opt. Express 27(12), 17262 (2019) — but literature treats this as SCATTERING with a TM>TE dependence, not modeled here as such.

C impurities `3500 dB/m, step, 50nm`

Robinson et al., arXiv:2606.19615 (2026)

Si impurities `3500 dB/m, step, 50nm`

No literature value found.
Engineering placeholder.

O impurities `5000 dB/m, step, 50nm`

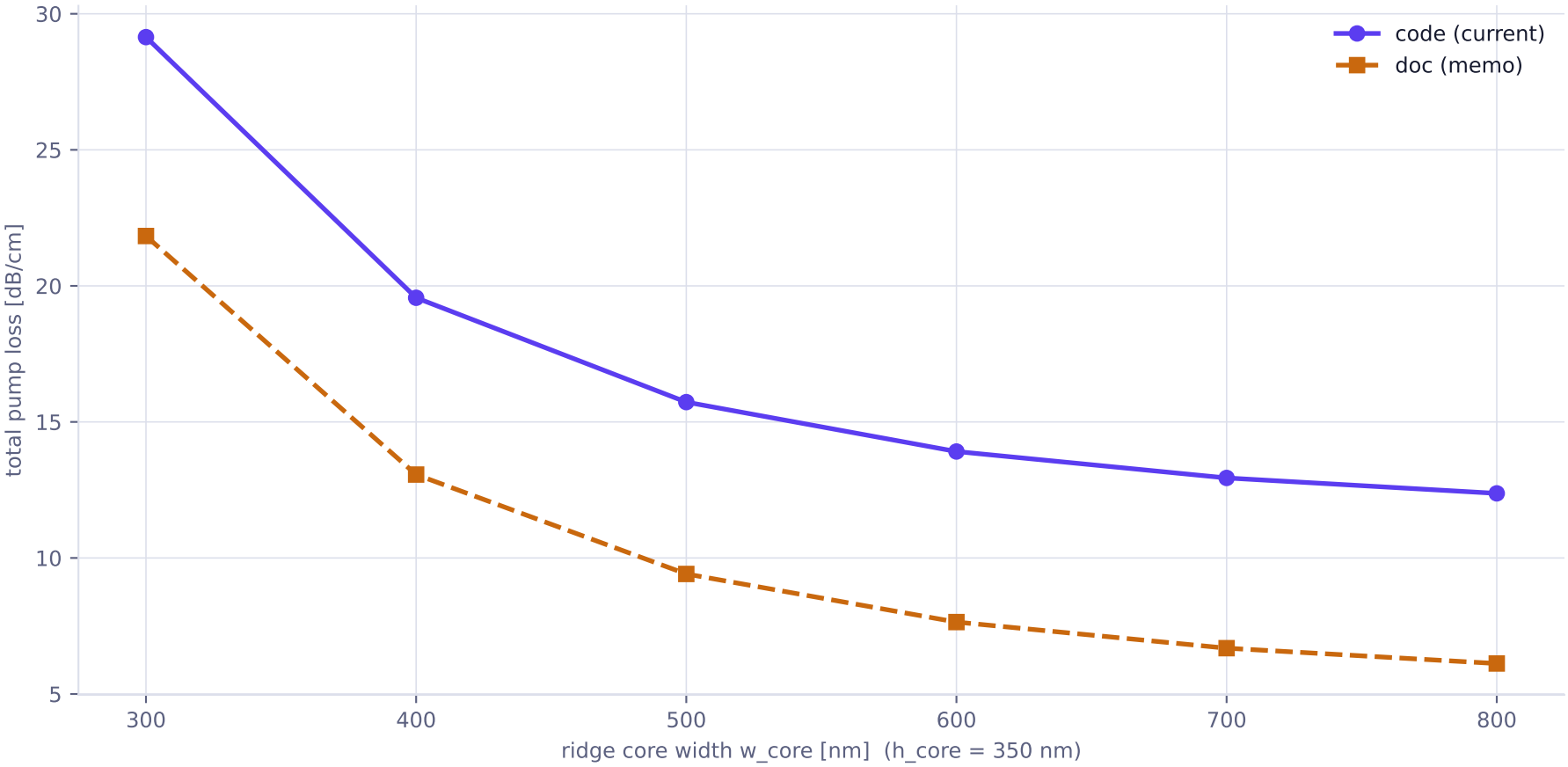
Bickermann et al., Appl. Phys. Lett. 95, 262104 (2009)

Not currently modeled at all (zero sidewall mechanisms in survey_config.py):

Oxidation ingress, sidewall contamination, sidewall damage — all three have no literature support either; the Loss Model Summary memo carries two of them at nonzero values (see section 2's comparison). Dropped here, not evaluated as zero-impact — just never added.

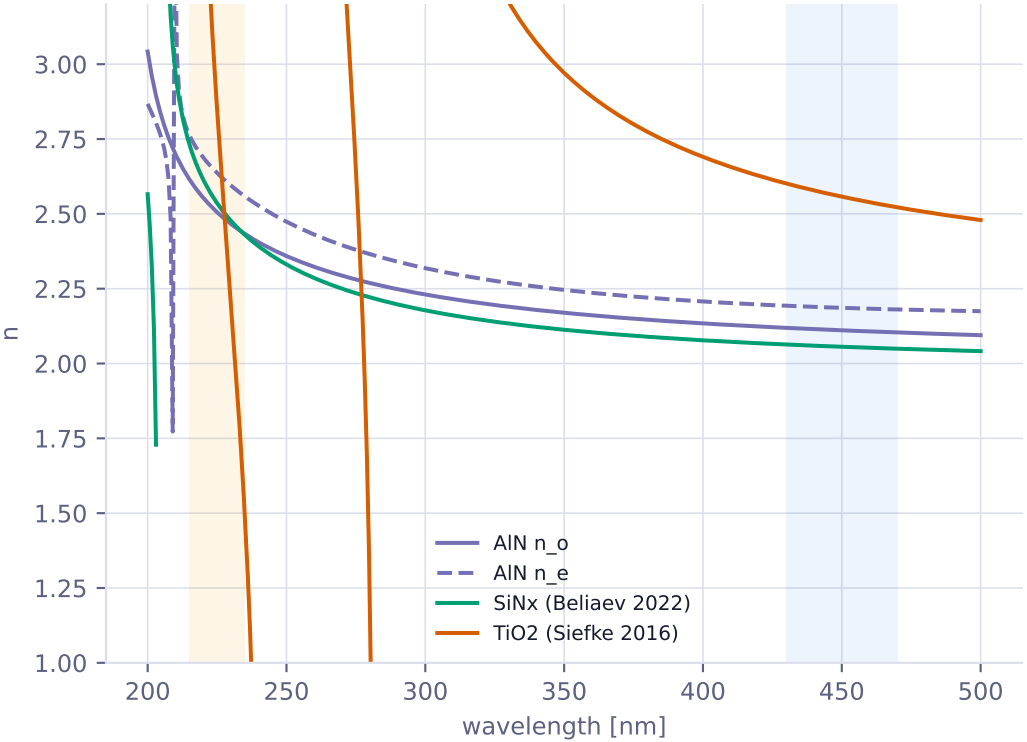
2. Pump-loss assumption comparison

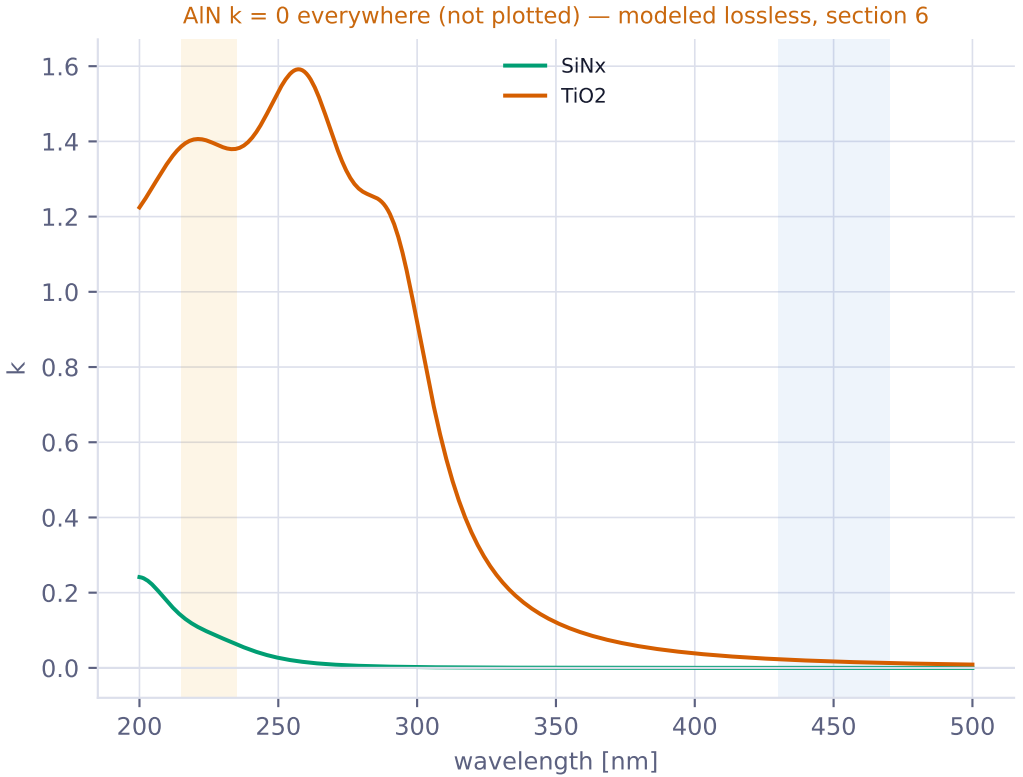
code = survey_config.py's current 4-mechanism set (section 1). doc = the "Loss Model Summary & Results" memo's own "Actual Inputs Used" table (7 mechanisms, different roughness). Computed from trial_grid's already-exported TM00 pump fields (ridge, h_core=350 nm fixed, no new EMode calls). Scattering's roughness difference (2.5 vs 2.0 nm sidewall) is applied as an analytic (RMS)^2 scaling to the combined EMode-native value, not a fresh VCM solve — a rougher approximation than the absorption-side comparison; see the script's docstring.



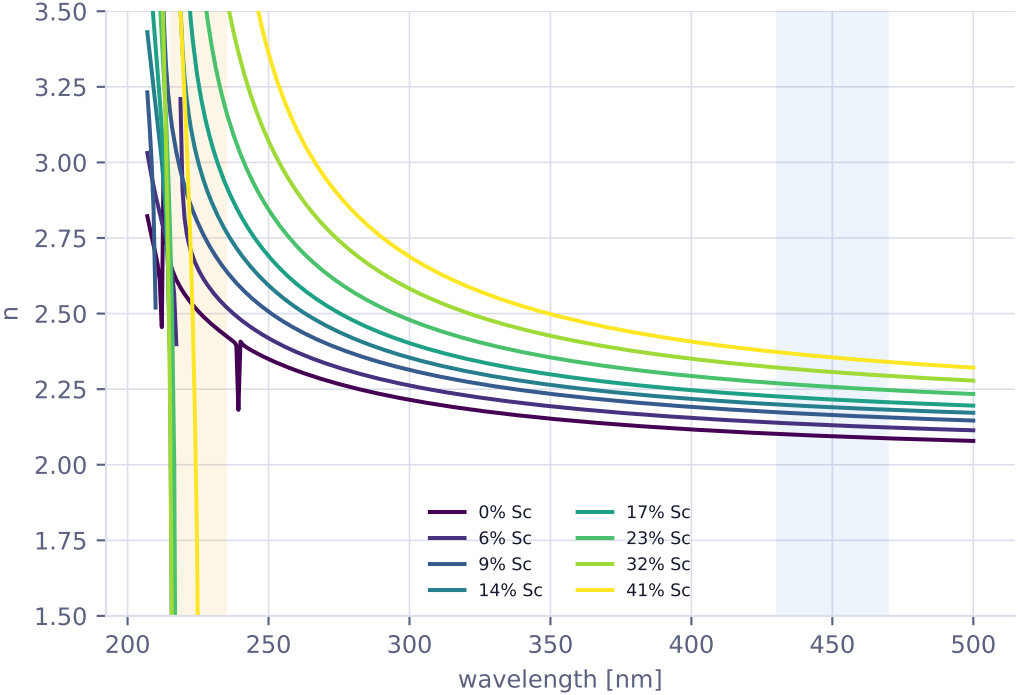
doc/code ratio across this width range: 0.49–0.75x — doc consistently LOWER than code, not higher, despite its extra sidewall terms (its exponential-decay, shorter-penetration-depth choices for C/Si/O more than offset that). Not an order-of-magnitude gap. Per 2026-10-12 direction: logged here, current code assumptions kept as-is.

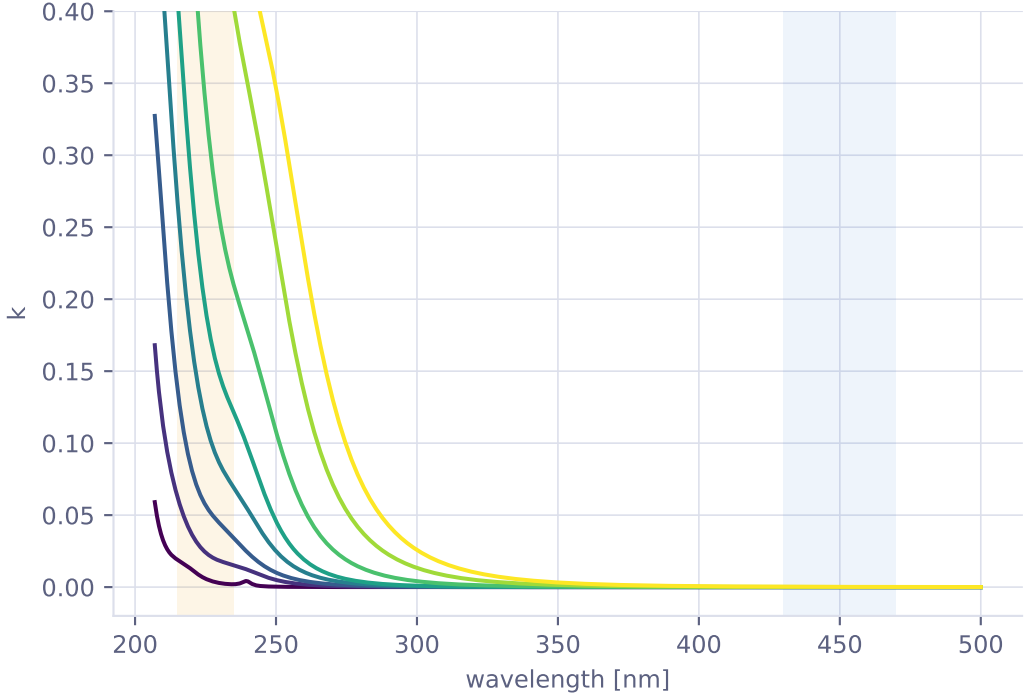
3. Core/cladding material dispersion





4. ScAlN composition sweep (index ready, k/d33 open)





Source: Baumler et al., J. Appl. Phys. 126, 045715 (2019), Fig. n/k; digitized by digitize_baumler.py (k resolution ~0
k resolution ~0.008, fit to 0 beyond 300.0 nm (digitization limit, not a physical statement) — UV k and the chi(2) d33/d31-vs-Sc
relationship are NOT from this fit and remain disputed; see section 6.

5. GaAlN: not yet sourced

No n(lambda)/k(lambda) dispersion fit exists for GaAlN (Al_xGa_1-xN) in this repo. This page documents the gap and what's known from a first literature pass, not a resolution.

Two independent motivations were identified for keeping GaAlN in the design matrix even with d33 enhancement deprioritized (user direction, 2026-10-12):

1. Index engineering for a Cerenkov cladding (composition tunes index, not nonlinearity).
2. As a loading strip that reshapes the AlN mode — pulling it from the substrate interface, or improving the AlN region's own overlap — without needing the strip itself active.

Composition-dependent d33 (NIST, Sanford et al.): decreases with increasing Al fraction x, with a SIGN CHANGE near x ~ 0.65. The favorable (higher-d33) direction is toward Ga-rich compositions — but GaN's bandgap (~3.4 eV) is well below the SH photon energy at 215-235 nm (~5.5 eV), so Ga-rich AlGaN is almost certainly strongly absorbing exactly where this project needs transparency. The useful composition window (enough Ga for index tuning, not so much that it absorbs the SH) is likely narrow and has not been checked quantitatively.

Needed before GaAlN can enter any sweep: n(lambda)/k(lambda) across 215-470 nm for a composition range still TBD (narrow, Al-rich, pending the transparency check above).

6. Nonlinear (chi(2)) tensor summary

wurtzite 6mm, c || y. Nonzero: d33; d31 = d32; d15 = d24. Py = eps0[d31(Ex^2+Ez^2) + d33 Ey^2], Px = 2 eps0 d15 Ex Ey, Pz = 2 eps0 d15 Ez Ey. Kleinman symmetry (d15=d31) assumed unless data says otherwise -- questionable near the SH band edge, treat d15 as separate.

AlN, bulk Majkic 2017, pssb 201700077	d33=4.3 +/- 0.3 (@1030nm) pm/V	d31=~0.1
AlN (working value) user's current value -- used throughout this project	d33=4.7 pm/V	d31=~0.1
AlN, sputter film Yoshioka 2021, APL Mater. 9, 101104	d33=5.1 +/- 0.4 pm/V	d31=0.07
ScAlN sputter, 10/20/28/36% Sc Yoshioka 2021	d33=15.8/42.5/46.9/62.3 pm/V	d31=0.84/2.4/3.4/4.5
ScAlN MBE on sapphire, 10/15/20/25% Lee et al., arXiv 2607.14590 (2026)	d33=-2.5/5.1/-3.1/3.2 (noisy) pm/V	d31=1.6/3.3/4.9/1.6

DISAGREEMENT

Sputtered films show strong, clean d33 enhancement with Sc content. MBE films (direct on sapphire, bypassing the AlN buffer) show d33 scattered/suppressed instead, with d31 showing the strong, clean enhancement there. Neither growth method has been measured anywhere near 215-235nm/430-470nm (both cited studies: ~1030nm pump). Implication: if d33 doesn't actually enhance for your growth process, a ScAlN core's real lever may be d31 (TE-pump -> TM-SH coupling, Py = d31*Ex^2), not d33 -- a different mode/polarization design than naively assuming 'bigger d33'. overlap_terms() in shg_physics.py already separates d33/d31/d15 contributions per crossing, so this is mechanically supported once real tensor values are chosen -- the open question is which values, not whether the code can use them.

7. Notes & provenance

Loss model source: "Loss Model Summary & Results", internal memo, Google Drive, created 2026-09-22 (shorthand used throughout this project: [Loss Model Summary, 2026-09-22]). Companion doc: "AlN_Absorption_Literature_Review" (same Drive folder).

Material fits: materials/fit_sinx_sellmeier.py (Beliaev et al., Thin Solid Films 763, 139568, 2022), materials/fit_tio2_sellmeier.py (Siefke et al., Adv. Opt. Mater. 4, 1780, 2016), materials/fit_baumler_sellmeier.py (Baumler et al., J. Appl. Phys. 126, 045715, 2019, digitized). AlN o/e equations hardcoded in geometry.py (AlN_EQ_O/AlN_EQ_E).

Pump-loss comparison: compare_pump_loss_assumptions.py, computed from trial_grid's already-exported TM00 pump fields -- no new EMode calls. Re-run that script directly to regenerate runs/pump_loss_assumption_comparison.csv.

This report: build_assumptions_report.py. Regenerate after any change to the loss model or material fits referenced above -- every per-sweep results PDF should cite this document's generation date rather than re-deriving any of this.